STRICCHETTI WITH SMASHED PEAS AND PROSCIUTTO

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
4-6	**1 h 30 min plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

300 g	Shelled English peas
56 g	Olive oil, for the peas
1 batch	Egg dough
42 g	Olive oil
370 g	Onion, finely diced
10 g	Garlic, finely chopped
75 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
45 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
80 g	Prosciutto, 40 g finely diced and 40 g julienned
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

1. Bring a small saucepan of water to the boil and salt it heavily.
2. Set up a salted ice-water bath with a colander standing in it. Salt in the bath is what holds the green of the peas.
3. Blanch the peas 1 to 2 minutes, until they start to soften, then lift them into the ice water with a spider. Leave the pan boiling, you need it twice more.
4. Once the peas have cooled, put them back through the boiling water and the ice bath two more times, until a fork or your fingertips crush them easily.
5. Take them out of the ice bath for the last time and turn them onto a kitchen towel to drain.
6. Tip the peas into a bowl and start mashing with a fork. Keep mashing while you drizzle in the 56 g olive oil, to a coarse mash with the texture of a rustic pesto. Set it aside.
7. Shape 624 g of stricchetti from the egg dough.
8. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil.
9. While the water heats, set a saute pan over low heat with the 42 g olive oil. Cook the onion gently 5 to 8 minutes, soft but without color, then add the garlic for 10 to 15 seconds, until it goes aromatic.
10. Stir the crushed peas into the onion and set the pan aside.
11. Cook the stricchetti 2 to 3 minutes. The center of the shape should be tender.
12. While they cook, put the pan back over low heat, add 3 ladles of pasta water, 170 g, and the butter, and swirl to emulsify.
13. Lift the pasta across with a spider, raise the heat to medium and toss 1 to 2 minutes to marry.
14. Off the heat, toss in half the parmigiano, then the diced prosciutto. A splash of pasta water loosens the sauce if it tightens. It is ready when it clings with a gloss.
15. Divide onto plates and finish with the julienned prosciutto, the rest of the parmigiano and pepper.

NOTES

Blanching and shocking three times gets the peas soft enough to mash without costing them their color or flavor. One long boil would take both.
The pea mash breaks down into the sauce once the pasta is married, so stop at rustic-pesto texture and do not take it smooth.
The 80 g piece of prosciutto splits in two: 40 g diced into the pan, 40 g julienned over the top.
Salt the ice bath as well as the boiling water.
Stricchetti are the same shape as farfalle. Peas and prosciutto is a spring pairing in Emilia-Romagna, usually with this shape or tagliatelle.

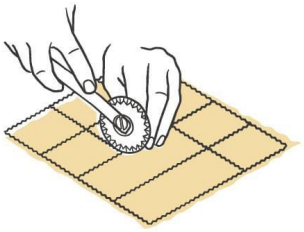
SHAPE
Stricchetti

Region: Emilia-Romagna, and across the rest of Italy under other names / Rest: 3 to 4 hours at room temperature

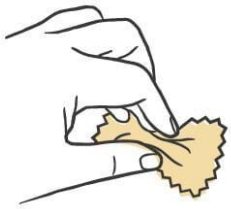
METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with a little 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Lay the sheets on the board and cut them into rectangles 1 1/2 by 2 inches with a fluted dough divider, or a fluted pastry cutter against a ruler. Keep them under wrap or a cloth as you go.
4. Put your index finger and thumb opposite each other at the middle of a rectangle and pinch the top and bottom edges together into a bow tie. Pinch hard; a loose center comes apart in the pot.
5. Shape the rest, laying them on the sheet pan in a single layer.
6. Dry 3 to 4 hours at room temperature, until the pinched center feels firm. To check, boil a single one and see whether it keeps its shape.
7. To hold it, wrap the pan in plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

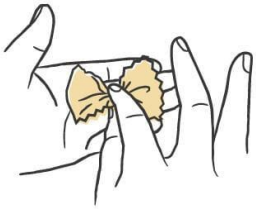
SHAPING



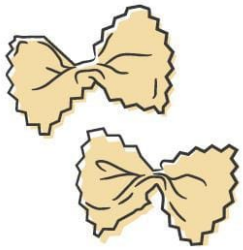
1



2



3



4



5

NOTES

Cut size is 1 1/2 by 2 inches, fluted on every edge, giving a finished bow tie about 2 inches long. Other makers go from about an inch up to considerably larger.
Needs a fluted dough divider or a fluted pastry cutter; a ruler helps keep the rectangles square. The forming gesture is a single hard finger-and-thumb pinch at the center, which is where the dialect name comes from.
This shape dries longer than any other egg pasta in the book, 3 to 4 hours rather than 1 to 2, because the pinch relaxes easily in boiling water. The boil-one test is the way to confirm it is dry enough.
Better known as farfalle, or bow-tie pasta.
Refrigerator limit is 24 hours.
In Emilia-Romagna it goes into sauces built on vegetables with a little meat: prosciutto and peas in springtime, sausage with cardoons or cavolo nero once it turns cold. Butter and parmigiano is the plain version.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.